

Although you may be cribbing about it now, you will soon get used to it... ask yourself how averse will you be to a tablet or phone that throws up the same UI in, say, two years?

Ahh! Now you're getting the picture, eh? However, we still believe it's a big mistake for Microsoft to take its PC users for granted. Think about how you use your devices - your phone (or tablet) has become your main consumption device for content. It's easy, it's with you always, and is light. So what if you have a smaller screen to read on, at least you can read while walking, and feel connected all the time.

When you want to sit and work, though, say you need to write out an article or do any serious typing, browse and do research, write code, design something, paint, edit videos, touch up pictures... you go to your laptop / desktop, fire up Windows (or Linux or Mac) and get productive. Microsoft are the productivity kings, and yes, the world is more about fun and consuming content than making it, and yes we will spend `40K on an iPhone if we can afford it, but we're not yet ready to let go of our PCs. Why? Because we still need to work. In its attempt to get you used to the UIs of their consumption devices, Microsoft is messing with your productivity. If you're less productive on a PC anyway, why bother with one. Why not a Chromebook? Why not buy a keyboard for your iPad/Android device and get used to working on that. It's painful, but now, so is Windows 8...

What we want: For Windows 9, we hope they get back to looking at the platforms for what they are, and give us variants of the OS that are more suited for the device it's installed on. Why do you need a touch interface on a device with no touchscreen? Even if it's not a Start menu-driven UI, at least we hope Windows 9 will have

two modes - Touch and Type. We don't expect the two OSes to get separated again (unless there's a miracle) but we do want an OS that was actually made with a keyboard and mouse in mind for PCs and with touch in mind for tablets / phones.

3. Touch is the future... is it?

Microsoft seem to have taken it for granted that touch is indeed the future. Apple's made its billions from touch, so why shouldn't Microsoft try and compete in the same market? For years, however, Microsoft's been the king of its castles - office suites and operating systems. However, just as Nintendo came and spoilt the Xbox party with the Wii, Microsoft has to spoil Apple's party by doing something better... And what do they have that's better than touch? Microsoft has Kinect. Over the years, when we've met Microsoft employees, we've always been told that Kinect is their vision of the future. Gesture control for everything. Why touch something when you can wave your hand at it from a distance. Phones may have no use for this, but a PC might. Developing the Kinect further to recognise a nod as a command, or to automatically increase font size if you are squinting... now that's futuristic.

What we want: We're hoping that Windows 9 will truly change the PC by adding gestures to the existing keyboard and mouse setup, and enhance our input experience. God knows the PC market could use a little change. Windows 8 is not that change because it frustrates you when you don't have a touch screen. Windows 9 can do this by integrating Kinect.

Windows 9

In Windows 8, the much touted Live Tiles are not really intuitive. For example, when you see changing pictures of friends, if you happen to spot a friend who you had for-

gotten about, and click their face, it just takes you to the people hub. Now if you want to go to that person, you have to search for them. For these tiles to be really live, or alive, it would be nice for them to link the tile state, so when you click (or tap), you go to what you clicked on. Now it's not going to be easy to accomplish this, and strictly speaking, it's really up to the app developer to do this, but in order to show off such functionality, Microsoft has to make it possible first.

The next most important thing we want from Windows 9 is to forget about the desktop. Yes you heard us. We'd rather Microsoft allow Windows 7 to run for longer, and offer support for it, with patches and service packs and whatnot, just as they did for XP (for a decade). It's fine. It runs, why bother PC users with a UI made for touch screens? Let touch devices make the most of Metro, without having to revert to a desktop mode for some things, and also give app developers some much needed respite, by making them think for the touch UI only.

We've mentioned Kinect earlier in this article, and Windows 9 really should look at changing things up and perhaps going even further than touch. Also, it would be good for Microsoft to finally think about letting the "Windows" badge go, because as people have said before, with Metro, it's more like "Microsoft Window" anyway, as the ability to launch and run multiple programs at once in multiple "Windows" is going away. Whatever the case, Windows 9 needs to bring sweeping changes, and take some tough decisions if it doesn't want to be the second failure after Windows 7. 

Windows 8 is worse than DOS?

Watch this video for a good laugh, about why some people hate Windows 8:
<http://y2u.be/WTYet-qf1jo>



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 GOOD DESIGN

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